

SELF-FULFILLMENT THROUGH SELF-REALIZATION AS MAN OR WOMAN

Greetings, my dearest friends. God bless all of you. Blessed be this hour.

To fulfill one's life, one must fulfill one's self. Self-fulfillment, or self-realization, happens on many levels of depth and in many different areas and respects. In order to fulfill oneself, one needs to find one's primary vocation and develop it, grow in and through it, cultivate it in every possible respect. In order to fulfill oneself, one needs to find and develop all one's potentials -- one's individual assets as well as all the general human ones with which every living human being is fundamentally endowed. It requires building up and integrating into the rest of the personality that which is free from obstructions. In order to do all that, it is essential to find and eliminate that which is obstructing and destructive. All this, as you know, means self-fulfillment. He who fulfills himself, contributes something to life. He enriches it not merely by his vocational abilities, but through his human contacts, through his ability to relate to others, to have fruitful contacts with his fellow creatures. Through self-development, barriers fall, fear of others and of oneself in connection with others vanishes and therefore true relatedness is possible.

Self-fulfillment also means something much more specific. Humanity consists of men and women. A human being cannot fulfill himself if he or she does not fulfill his manhood or womanhood. This must be the primary aim on which everything else is hinged and either very directly or indirectly connected with. Tonight let us discuss this subject a little more in detail.

These lectures are predominantly destined for those friends who follow this path of intensive self-development. The lectures affect those inner areas which are not accessible unless such a path is taken. Hence, many of my friends feel an inner echo and an understanding of these words which goes beyond a mere intellectual and theoretical grasp of the subject. Sometimes this understanding comes only a bit later when the necessary layers of consciousness become free. However, all those who do work on the path can sooner or later make use of these lectures in an entirely different way than those friends who merely listen and read the lectures. This difference is distinct and real, but can be ascertained only when knowing both kinds of understanding. When the inner experience of truth is lacking because self-development in its vital form is not practiced, these lectures may be either merely interesting or self-evident material or far-fetched theory. When you are affected inside of your being, it will be a helpful experience that enables you to further transcend yourself, to understand your problems in a more profound way. Self-exploration makes forever new layers of your psyche accessible to your awareness. The lectures are directly aimed at these layers as they come up.

No path of self-realization can exist without bringing forth one's attitude toward one's own manhood or womanhood, respectively, and one's approach and attitude to the opposite sex. Many a path is taken when the person wants to skirt around this issue, hoping it can be avoided because it is

so unpleasant to look at, and the most obvious signs, coming forth from the psyche, are disregarded. The greater the resistance to openly face a problem, the more important is it to do so. You all know that.

Considerable work has been done in this respect in your private sessions, and we have discussed this topic repeatedly in previous lectures, from various angles. But it is important to discuss this topic again.

You all know the common fact that all human beings possess both masculine and feminine traits. But there is still so much lack of clarity, so much confusion regarding this topic, even among my friends as it is with most human beings. There are some whose conscious concepts are quite reasonable and truthful, but unconsciously almost all human beings harbor some distorted ideas on this subject. These distorted concepts create fear of the other sex, fear of one's own proper functioning in the sex one is born in. Such fears are, quite naturally, a barrier preventing relatedness to the opposite sex, and this relatedness is one of the important aspects of self-fulfillment. Relating to other human beings is always a gauge of one's own inner freedom and integration. The relationship between the sexes, the most intense form of human communication, is therefore even more influenced by inner conflict and strife.

When a barrier exists to the opposite sex, a similar barrier must primarily exist to oneself regarding one's own sex. When a man fights against his own masculinity and is confused about it, it creates a barrier, so he must fight against woman. The same applies, of course, to woman. Age old misconceptions handed down from one generation to the next have a tragic influence on mankind, particularly in this respect. People, consciously or unconsciously, reverse the facts into exact opposites -- that which is healthy, constructive, and good appears undesirable, and vice versa. Hence, their attitude to themselves in this respect is distorted, and one's entire value system suffers by unrealistic reflexes. To be more specific, if the drive toward union is a priori experienced as something wrong, it is inevitable to discourage the healthy striving of the soul; to be confused about it; to feel isolating, separating tendencies as being more constructive or mature. Hence, one fears all natural impulses toward union. One fears the self which produces them and, as a protection, creates a barrier to the opposite sex. This not only separates man from woman, but it splits the great cosmic force within itself (affection and the procreative urge). When human beings experience (regardless of how unconscious this may be) the sex force as something wrong, they must fear their own sex, fear themselves as men or women. They must distrust themselves in this respect. They can never afford to be free and spontaneous, constantly holding themselves in check. How can true overall growth be affected with such inner timidity and lack of freedom? How can the spirit surge forward in harmony with the cosmic flow? How can an entity learn the all-encompassing love which knows no barriers?

The universe strives toward union in every possible respect. All the forces of nature, all the forces within the human being reach out toward union, again, on all levels of being. Where there is error and blindness, fear must come into existence, and consequently this universal flow must be stopped, evolution halted.

One of the tragic human conflicts is the fact that human beings desperately yearn for their fulfillment as men and women with their counterparts, and often equally desperately flee from it in unreasonable fear. This fear need not exist, and not existing, the tragic conflict would not exist. It is

as though nature constantly shows that the happiness of self-fulfillment is a part of life which cannot be denied, should not be squashed. But humanity, in its blindness and false modesty, does not understand. It misinterprets this benign voice that invites it to follow its blissful destiny, and often ascribes it to "the Devil's temptation." As long as humanity cannot discriminate between what is constructive and destructive, it must be in such a tragic and so unnecessary a conflict which obstructs self-realization.

Life speaks so clearly, and man, steeped in and impregnated with false concepts, does not hear or see. For example, my friends on the path again and again experience that whenever a real insight, a deep recognition is made, a surge of new strength and energy, joy of life, hopefulness, and brightness come forth. And also, specifically, the erotic element manifests in this experience of the life force. The erotic force is an integral part of the life force. They are inseparable. So whenever you gain truth about yourself, it is as though a channel opens within yourself, tuning you into this life-giving force. And only when misgivings and apprehension and the old, as yet unresolved problems gain an upper hand all over again, does this channel close up, and you are again separate. Stagnation, gray hopelessness, set in again. But when you move in truth, when you keep on being alive by facing the truth about yourself, to that degree must you be enveloped and permeated with this vibrant, life-giving force which knows no barriers and no fear.

When you ponder over this phenomenon that everyone on the path can experience, you must come to the realization that what is said here is truth. If truth brings eros, and eros brings union, and all of these facets make fear and distrust and insecurity disappear, it shows the unity of life, and it proves the untruth of concepts which have bred separateness. If you truly meditate on this topic, you will, for yourself personally, see some very significant factors.

The world harbors many untruthful ideas about what is specifically masculine and feminine, making it even more difficult to overcome the basic fear to transcend oneself in the other sex. Each sex feels unfairly put upon and resents its own supposed disadvantages, competing with the other sex for its advantages. Hence men secretly envy women for their privileged position of not having to fight to quite the same degree as the man has to in order to survive. His responsibilities are heavier. His failure to be successful is much more indicative of his personal failure. More is expected of him. Women envy men their privileged position of greater freedom, of being recognized by the world as the superior sex. But these envies and resentments are superficial in comparison with the deeper fear of losing oneself.

Many distinctions between the sexes are arbitrary and unrealistic. But, of course, there are also some which are true. They are wholeheartedly embraced by the healthy person. The more they are embraced, the less is the barrier between the self and one's sexual role -- consequently the greater the union with the opposite sex. This lack of anxiety, distrust, and barriers sets a healthy flow in motion which causes the entity to come out of itself and be capable of the true relatedness which makes the distinction and difference disappear. In rare moments of bliss, this can be experienced right in this life on earth. The disappearance of distinction is not to be confused with its distorted counterpart in which men become feminine and women masculine. Every divine truth can be distorted. You all know that. So it is here. Fear of one's own sex and therefore of the opposite sex levels off the difference through diminishing masculinity and femininity and assuming the traits of the very sex one fights against. But embracing oneself as the sex one represents, thereby embracing

the other sex, and therefore becoming more masculine or more feminine unifies through acceptance, understanding, strength, love, truth.

Let us briefly recapitulate what was said previously, in different contexts. One of the main barriers of man against his masculinity is the fear of losing himself. He fears not only self-loss due to the necessary discipline of fulfilling his responsibilities, which appears as a disadvantage and sacrifice and therefore a loss of self in that sense. But he also fears it due to the letting go of himself in a full relationship. In this sense, discipline seems to be given up, and this is considered as perilous. Therefore he is confused between discipline and the ability to let go of himself. In fear and misconception, he uses both in the wrong way. He holds on where letting go would be productive and harmonious, and he refuses discipline and self-responsibility where this would be functional for his self-realization. If one is out of kilter, the entire inner balance must be upset. To the degree man learns to be responsible for himself in the true, deeper sense of the word, to that degree must his fear of letting go of himself disappear so that letting go of himself and disciplining himself both function in a unifying way, while the person who is isolated behind barriers also practices both inner activities, but in reverse.

The same applies to woman, but from a different angle. Woman fears the apparent helplessness of giving herself up, of surrendering herself. Thereby she defeats her femininity and in the end becomes more helpless and dependent. The more control she exerts, the more false discipline does she use in order to prevent the dreaded self-loss, the weaker and more dependent does she become on other levels of her personality -- either emotionally dependent in the need of being excessively loved and approved, mentally dependent in order to excel over others, or even physically and materially dependent. Her resourcefulness as a human being suffers to the degree that she defeats and discourages the functioning of her femininity. So she, too, fluctuates between discipline and letting go of herself, both in the wrong way and both prohibitive of self-fulfillment. When man refuses responsibility, not only in his vocational or everyday life but more specifically in his emotional life, out of fear of a burden, he burdens himself more while simultaneously isolating himself from all that his spirit yearns for. And when woman refuses the apparent helplessness of self-surrender by exerting an artificial and unhealthy control, she becomes even more helpless while at the same time isolating herself and forfeiting her destiny. For such is the spiritual law.

In health, the two primary aspects of discipline and of letting go -- they might well be termed as the prototypes of masculine and feminine aspects -- exist in both sexes but are arrived at from opposite sides. When man accepts his full responsibility on all levels of his being, with all that this entails, he can then let go of himself without danger. When woman does not in fear, pride, and self-will fight her destiny, she must gain the strength and selfhood which give her full security in herself. She finds herself by losing herself. He loses himself by finding himself. And they are both the same!

When discipline and letting go of oneself occur through wisdom, truth, strength, freedom, love, the result is unity and self-fulfillment. Harmony with the universal forces is established; continuous supply of the life force regenerates and unifies all personality levels. When discipline and letting go of oneself occur through blindness, weakness, fear, lack of inner freedom, error, the result must be separateness and stagnation.

These two principles might be visualized as primary motivating cosmic forces of the human entity. It all depends on the manner in which they are used. The disharmony created by misusing these forces simultaneously creates unrest and inner worry. For, the deep knowledge that the soul cannot fulfill itself to its maximum potential, that it is missing out on what is available for all beings can never be entirely squelched. It is only a question of understanding the inner message.

These words are of course very theoretical and abstract. Just reading or hearing them merely opens a philosophical concept. But when you are seriously engaged in the pathwork, you will fill in the gaps by deep personal experience of how these words apply to you, in what way and why. Many of my friends have already made very important recognitions in this respect.

These masculine and feminine principles -- discipline and strength versus self-surrender and letting go of the self -- in the last analysis meet and become one so that the one becomes the other and each helps the other to integrate more fully and harmoniously with the other. Through healthy strength, flexible discipline, mature self-responsibility, the entity becomes strong enough not to fear self-surrender and wise enough not to do so indiscriminately. Through healthy, relaxed openness and outgoingness, the personality finds the strength and discipline required to live productively in union -- by living self-sufficiently as an individual.

The beginning of establishing this benign cycle of interflowing movement between the masculine and the feminine principles has to be made by determining where your specific fears exist. This is not always easy, for they are so hidden. They manifest so subtly, and yet so distinctly if once you begin to be aware of them. Try to ascertain to what extent and in what respect you fear and resent the role of your own sex, and therefore avoid contact with the opposite sex. Where do you believe are the "injustices" you unconsciously exaggerate in order to hold on to yourself so as not to risk the "danger" of self-forgetfulness. This is a much more fundamental aspect of this problem than the more superficial rebellion against sexual injustice. Try to reach this level of awareness in which a much deeper fear of losing yourself exists. Once you are aware of it, you can truly examine and overcome this obstructing fear which divides you within.

You may well argue that it is justified to be on guard. Are not many people out to take advantage of one's love or one's need to love and be loved? Does self-forgetfulness not create stronger needs which may be frustrated? Does this not mean more intense pain when rejection occurs? The answer to the first question is yes. It is true that many people are too childishly selfish not to abuse openness and outgoingness if the latter occurs blindly and in a spirit of wishful thinking. The answer to the other two questions is no. Healthy involvement does not bring more pain than isolation. Fulfilling one's needs only partially does not make them more stringent than when they are denied altogether.

However, there is a never failing key to this problem which, when used, will do away with the conflict. This makes it possible to use cautious wisdom while not having to hold on to yourself and thereby restraining the best qualities and outgoing forces. Once you have found and used this key, your life must change drastically. The key is the willingness to see the reality even if you do not welcome it.

In the last lecture, we discussed the topic of needs. We continue from there, linking these two topics. If you are unaware of your needs and the intensity of them because you have displaced

them, this blindness must make you equally blind to other people around you who are supposed to fulfill your needs. This key does not represent an insurmountable feat. It is very much within the realm of the possible to utilize it. Becoming aware of your needs, their original direction and force, directly leads you to an awareness of how much others are capable or willing to fulfill them. If you can face these facts, being able to first stand the frustration of your will, wisdom and perception of truth are forever your guiding lights, showing you how reasonable and productive it is in any given instance to have expectations and therefore to let go of yourself. There are basically four aspects that you often fight against in blindness. This applies, as of now, to most human beings. The four aspects are (1) the lack of awareness of their real and specific needs, (2) the extent and urgency of such needs, (3) the frequent lack of awareness of who, specifically, is supposed to fulfill the need and, often, in what particular way (all original desires being displaced), and (4) the extent of ability or disability, willingness or unwillingness of the other person to satisfy the full extent of this need. Therefore your relationships become fraught with friction, with misunderstandings, with hurts, with real or imagined rejection. This must lead to withdrawal in one form or another. But if you are aware of these four aspects, only to some degree, you become instantly capable of evaluating the interaction between yourself and others in question. The intensity of the need may not be automatically diminished, but to the degree of your awareness of it, it becomes bearable. As it becomes bearable, you no longer need illusion and wishful thinking. You can look the truth in the face, accepting what is, no matter how imperfect, no matter how far from what you wish at present. Your blind needs issue blind, unconscious demands which are often quite impossible to fulfill. The moment you are aware of it, you can also envisage the fact that someone else may be personally unsuited for filling your need, and you may relinquish your demands. No longer displacing your needs will generally mature you sufficiently to be able to stand frustration, if it need be. This discipline and the self-responsibility of facing the reality of the situation makes you grow and inevitably increases self-respect, self-liking, and a sense of security in yourself.

Apart from the frequent unreasonableness of unconscious excessive demands on your part, it may also happen that your demands are in themselves quite reasonable, but others may be driven into a different direction and are incapable of fulfilling them. This has nothing to do with rejecting you. Once you truly see the truth, gain the insight into these interplays, the freedom you will have gained cannot be measured in words. Your ability to observe yourself, and consequently others, in a spirit of objective detachment, ascertaining trouble spots without guilt or anger, is the healthiest way conceivable of practicing discipline and self-responsibility. This way, you can face the reality of the relationship in question, and therefore fear will vanish. If you can accept a no without becoming an angry or hurt child within yourself, then independence and self-respect consistently grow and give you sufficient security to truly let go to the extent commensurate with the occasion and to the extent healthy at any given phase of your life. The limits, however, are not set by mechanisms of fear and distrust but are simply one's present potentials in this respect. The ability to stand the frustration of your will and to relinquish it, if need be, and your ability to face what is, rather than closing your eyes in wishful thinking and in a forcing current because you do not wish to give up your will, as well as the ability to objectively evaluate the unreasonableness of your demands, will open the flow of true relatedness.

So, my friends, let us briefly recapitulate. Self-fulfillment is dependent on fulfilling yourself as man or woman. Both manhood and womanhood can only be fulfilled by recognizing your barriers and fears regarding the full functioning of your manhood or womanhood. Consequently, the barrier to the other sex must go. In order to accomplish this, determine and experience the extent of your

fear or your holding back, which are a result of blindness and unwillingness to objectively evaluate others and yourself. Even those of you who are most actively engaged in this pathwork and have made most remarkable progress are as yet utterly unaware of the strength of unreasonable demands and commands that you issue into your surroundings. It is all so easily rationalized, covered up, explained away. If you can only look at the raw demands you issue forth, if you can just face that, my dearest friends, you will no longer fear the demands others make on you because then, and only then, can you cope with them. If you can then take these raw demands with a little laughter at your childishness, you can begin to evaluate the situation in relation to reason, justice, fairness. A large step will be taken forward if this is acquired. This step directly leads to freedom from fear, distrust, insecurity, isolation, separateness, stagnation. It must open the door to full relating and living, to immeasurable happiness every individual human soul desperately yearns for.

I cannot emphasize strongly enough that you look at your demands without excuse, and, thereupon, you will be able to encounter the demands of others. For do you not know that your unconscious excessive demands make you prone to the unconscious excessive demands of others? And these two forces make a real relatedness absolutely impossible. For, as long as excessive one-sided demands exist due to lack of awareness of one's needs, disappointment and fear must create a barrier of separateness. Follow through this sequence, my dearest friends.

Are there any questions?

QUESTION: The demands are so hard to find. We all know that we have them, and yet it is very hard to find what they are.

ANSWER: It is really not as hard as you think if you approach it in the following way. Whenever there is a friction between yourself and others, look at your naked feelings by asking yourself what you expect of the other, what would you want, or what do you fear that they demand or want from you? If you look at confused, disturbed, disharmonious feelings, you must dare to be irrational, having the courage to let the unreasonable child manifest on the surface. To the extent you can do so, you must gain information about your innermost self, unadorned by superimposed rationalizations. In this way, you will find your demands and can subsequently come to terms with them. Face your anger that your demands often remain unfulfilled. Also face your apprehension of other people's demands on you, which may vaguely feel as a stream coming to you. The more you realize your demands, the better can you cope with those silent, subtle currents of demands flowing to you, which have in the past made you compulsive, guilty, confused, and wavering.

A disharmonious mood will so often yield unconscious needs and demands, either yours or those of others that you cannot cope with. Sometimes it is both. It is impossible to cope with something, the existence of which one consciously ignores but only feels as a dull, vague force. The minute you can pinpoint in clear-cut terms what you previously did not dare to acknowledge because it was uncomfortable or beneath your dignity, you become strong and capable. The procedure is simple, provided you take the daring step to own up to unreasonable feelings, requests, unfair demands, childish selfishness. Let the irrational voice reach your surface awareness, which exists in the most reasonably contained personality. View it with a little distance and detachment and a maximum of honesty. You are all so indoctrinated with a compulsion to cover up this little voice. Relatedness, the true flow of union, is determined directly by this chain reaction. Facing the selfish greedy child within you brings liberation, dignity, and strength, which in turn enables

relatedness in the most satisfying way. In this way, you truly become men and women, fulfilling the destiny of your sex.

The factors discussed here tonight appear to be far apart from one another. On the one hand, I discussed self-fulfillment in a cosmic sense; on the other, I speak about the immediacy of the selfish child dwelling, to some extent, in all individuals. But these two aspects of human life are so interwoven, so interconnected! Only when facing this little child, unadorned, as it exists, can it begin to grow out of itself into its spiritual potentials so that the ability to risk of oneself is acquired. Then you will no longer have to hold on in the pseudosafety of isolation. However, you cannot risk of yourself if you cannot trust others. How can you trust others if you do not even know what they ask of you and what you ask of them? And how can you trust yourself if you persist in blinding yourself to your real needs, your demands, the childish voice requesting angrily and endlessly? Only when you know this aspect of yourself can you trust yourself. Only when you perceive reality around you and in others, at least as far as your needs are concerned, can you come to terms with that and trust your ability to do so. When you are capable of enduring frustration of your will in equanimity and harmony, you can indeed trust life, and therefore you can relate and fulfill yourself. What is more, you are then equipped to find the partner you need because your eyes are open. You do not keep them deliberately shut because you prefer to cling to a rosy illusion due to your unwillingness to stand frustration. So, my friends, look at this chain reaction. It must work in that order.

It will be useful if my friends participate more actively in the discussions following the lectures. Real participation would be of great help which you do not utilize. This is to your detriment. Even if you have not reached these specific levels of awareness in your private work, it is possible to study the lectures and determine when you are confused, in what respect you remain unresponsive. Determining this will prove very revealing for your immediate problems. When you come with the question of what you do not really understand and why, the answer may help to open the way. Even if there is no personal inner response to something said in a lecture, that should not in the least deter you from participation, but, quite to the contrary, furnish material for participation.

Now, my dearest friends, study, meditate, and try to assimilate in your work the material given to you. If you can only experience these words to some extent, it truly means a new life. It also means the inner understanding of self-fulfillment. For only then can you contribute to life in the true sense of the word. Man can contribute to life by his works, but this will leave something to be desired. Some spark of aliveness must be missing if the self is not fulfilled. For this is indeed the life flow without which all deeds, all actions, all contributions to living, remain somewhat stale.

Be blessed, every one of you. Receive love and strength from the universal forces which are all around you and deep within yourself if you but tap this source through such a path. Be in peace, be in God!

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